

Meaning in Context - Workbook 3

Focused practice - Workbook 3 of 3

How to use this workbook

Read each short text closely. Answer without checking the key. Then compare your reasoning with the explanation and mark the mistake type if you were wrong.

Before you start

- Underline or mentally mark the exact wording that controls your answer.
- Do not choose an option just because it is true in general; it must fit this text.
- After checking, write one sentence explaining why the strongest wrong answer fails.

Night Shift

By 2 a.m., the hospital lobby had become quiet in a different key: not empty, but hushed with people speaking softly and moving carefully around sleeping families.

1. What does quiet in a different key suggest?

- A. The lobby played music in another key.
- B. The quiet had a different quality than ordinary emptiness.
- C. The lobby became completely silent.
- D. The hospital changed its security code.

2. Which words most clearly explain the phrase?

- A. By 2 a.m.
- B. hospital lobby
- C. not empty, but hushed
- D. families

Museum Labels

The curator asked writers to pitch the labels at visitors who had no specialist knowledge, using short explanations rather than technical vocabulary.

3. What does pitch mean here?

- A. throw physically
- B. set at an appropriate level
- C. make darker
- D. sell at an auction

4. What clue is most important?

- A. curator
- B. labels
- C. using short explanations rather than technical vocabulary
- D. visitors

Reusable Cups

The cafe owner said the deposit system had finally caught on after several weeks of slow participation. By the end of the month, most regular customers were returning cups.

5. What does caught on mean?

- A. became popular or widely used
- B. was physically attached
- C. was discovered as a mistake
- D. started a fire

6. Which sentence provides the strongest confirmation?

- A. The cafe owner said
- B. after several weeks
- C. most regular customers were returning cups
- D. By the end of the month

Answer key and reasoning

Night Shift

1. B. The colon explains that the lobby is not empty; its quiet comes from careful behavior around sleeping families.
2. C. That contrast directly defines the kind of quiet the writer means.

Museum Labels

3. B. The explanation about visitors without specialist knowledge shows that the writing level should be adjusted for that audience.
4. C. That wording shows how the labels should be pitched to the audience.

Reusable Cups

5. A. The rise from slow participation to most regular customers shows adoption.
6. C. That sentence demonstrates that the system became widely used.

Mistake review

- If you chose a familiar meaning that did not fit the context, label it wrong sense.
- If you chose an option based on one word but ignored the rest of the passage, label it one-clue trap.
- If you understood the basic meaning but missed attitude or effect, label it effect missed.
- Redo the question later without looking at the key.